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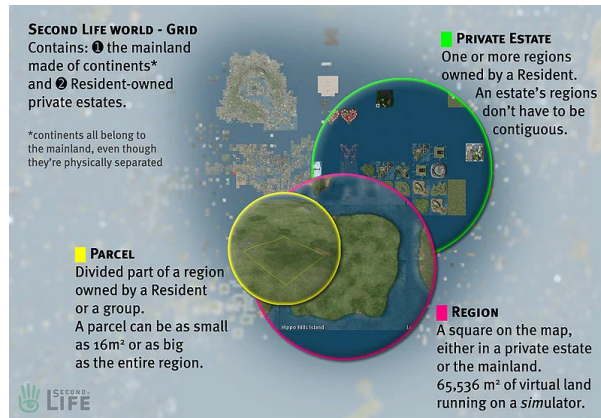
NODE MAP OVERVIEW & MULTI-MEDIA BLUEPRINT

1 Sub-Topic 1: Connecting Metaverse Ethics to Information Ethics (~300 Words)

1.1 Node 1.1: The Metaverse as an embodiment space: Datafication vs. Stewardship

- **Provocative Hook:** Is the Metaverse an expansion of human freedom, or a raw data prison?
- **Core IE Motivated Argument:** Information Ethics (IE) views virtual reality as an extension of Floridi’s *infosphere* where informational “beings” exist (Himma & Tavani, 2008). Instead of an amoral playground, users enter as *homo poieticus*—creative stewards duty-bound to prevent informational *entropy* (the corruption of reality and truth) (Himma & Tavani, 2008). The core ethical dilemma is whether the Metaverse fosters human flourishing or commodifies human existence into data streams, a tension explored by (Capurro, 2006).

- **Multi-Media Cue:** Guided numbered picture scroll of a preamble to second life economy, scandal 1, then scandal 2. Captions are placed under pictures to explain.



(Linden, 2011)

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Class action claims fraud in Second Life land sales

A new class action lawsuit is calling the virtual [Second Life](#) a bait-and-switch scheme. The plaintiffs claim that the virtual world, which was once looked at as the future of entertainment, lured thousands of customers by promising upon its launch in 2003 to confer property rights to users. Unlike Blizzard's World of Warcraft and Sony's Everquest, Linden Labs' "Second Life" didn't restrict user ownership interests in its terms of service and frequently touted that it was going to allow users (via their avatars) the right to buy and sell intellectual property such as homes and merchandise. Did the company go too far?

BY ERIQ GARDNER DECEMBER 21, 2010 10:57AM

(Gardner, 2010)

NBC NEWS

WATCH

Alan Greenspan admitted last month that lending institutions could not always be trusted to regulate themselves. He could have taken a cue sooner by looking at the 2007 collapse of Ginko Financial, a virtual investment bank in the online game Second Life.

ADD TO GOOGLE

Nov. 22, 2008, 1:33 AM GMT+2 / Source: LiveScience

By By Jeremy Hsu

(Hsu, 2008)

At the end a food for thought ending. “These are examples of whether to disregard human dignity and the rights they demand simply because their values and sense of being are commodified in a data stream. Some people might not take these seriously however this is worth thinking about the sentimental data forms people have that may not be this Second Life game.”

1.2 Node 1.2: The Social Complacency of Multiplayer Games Virtual Evil

- **Provocative Hook:** How do video game UIs turn ordinary gamers into cold, button-pushing virtual war criminals?
- **Core IE Motivated Argument:** In MMOGs and strategy games (*Defcon*, *EVE Online*), games reward mechanical efficiency (points, numbers going up) while stripping away semantic feedback which (Sicart, 2008, 2009) refers to as the “banality of simulated evil”. Rule engines abstract human suffering into UI metrics, players become unthinking bureaucrats of virtual destruction (Sicart, 2009). While not leading to overt evil in the Infosphere as defined by Floridi (Himma & Tavani, 2008), this suggests players are rewarded for lack of deep reflection, background static of moral numbness. This culture becomes reinforced through online multiplayer play, beyond similar single player games.
- **Multi-Media Cue:**
 - Audio-visual node playing *Defcon*’s nuclear strikes (minimalist radar + muffled crying audio) alongside real player voice-chats cheering for maximum kill counts (Sicart, 2008).

2 Sub-Topic 2: Does Violence in MMOGs Impact Real Life? (~300 Words)

2.1 Node 2.1: Does Violence in MMOGs Impact Real Life? Considerations Over Varying Scopes (~300 Words)

- **Provocative Hook:** Crime rates drop as game sales rise—so why are we still obsessed with virtual slaughter?
- The “contamination thesis” asserts game violence leaks into real-world aggression (Goerger, 2017). However, macro-data disproves the “contamination thesis” (games do not turn players into real-world mass shooters)

(Goerger, 2017; Schulzke, 2010). However, macro-crime analysis miss cultural context [Node 2.3: Satire, Tragedy vs. Atrocity Porn \(The Endorsement View\)](#), and more microscopic lenses where changes can be induced or correlated with certain individuals. Schulzke and Ostritsch argue games operate inside a “magic circle” where virtual actions lack victims (Ostritsch, 2017; Schulzke, 2010). The moral question then shifts to whether a game *glorifies* depravity or *forces critical reflection* (Goerger, 2017; Sicart, 2009). Violent games contain nuanced, non-uniform nature. Further they do not automatically force so much as reveal the nuanced, non-uniform tastes of *their player*; how they handle learning from the moral experiences presented in the game, and comment introspectively upon their own nature relative to the game.

- [Link to Node 1.2: The Social Complacency of Multiplayer Games](#)
[Virtual Evil](#): Some players might display boredom in terms of ethical engagement and engage with the game for other reasons they do not introspect upon.

- **Multi-Media Cue:** Interactive slider charting video game sales against youth violent crime rates over 30 years (showing inverse correlation)(Schulzke, 2010).
 - Simple interaction idea is to hide each year of the graph either with the slider or by clicking the chart to reveal more years. Everytime they increase the slider or click to reveal, they see the amount of crime for that year.
 - Before they click, they are asked to guess whether they think it will decrease or increase for the next year.
 - They are then told they can research more if their guess was wrong and they want to learn why, with a link to where the chart is from.

2.2 Node 2.2: Games as Virtue Scaffolding

- **Provocative Hook:** Can playing a violent game make you a *more* virtuous person (Schulzke, 2010)?
- **Core Argument & Theoretical Connection:** Wonderly uses Humean sentimentalism to argue ultra-violent gaming erodes empathy (Wonderly, 2008) Rebutting this, Schulzke demonstrates via Kant that virtual attacks carry no intent to harm real people (Schulzke, 2010), and via Aristotle that choice-engine games (*Fallout 3*, *The Last of Us*) serve as moral simulators to practice virtuous decision-making (Goerger, 2017; Schulzke, 2010)

- **Multi-Media Cue:** Decision-tree node showing the moral dilemmas from *Fallout 3* OR *The Witcher Series*, showing how moral engines scaffold ethical reflection.

2.3 Node 2.3: Satire, Tragedy vs. Atrocity Porn (The Endorsement View)

- **Provocative Hook:** Why is torturing in *GTA V* satirically defensible, but playing *KZ Manager* morally abhorrent (Ostritsch, 2017)?
- **Core Argument & Theoretical Connection:** Goerger and Ostritsch argue that graphic nature alone does not dictate morality; context and value integration do (Goerger, 2017; Ostritsch, 2017). Under Ostritsch's *Endorsement View*, representing evil (*GTA V*) is not immoral if framed satirically, as moral tragedy (*The Last of Us*, *The Witcher 3*), whereas endorsing an abhorrent worldview (*KZ Manager*, *Hatred*, *RapeLay*) violates moral obligations (Ostritsch, 2017).
- **Multi-Media Cue:**
 - PANE 1 - Poll and discussion: **[30-Second Timer]** “In 1989, a text-and-graphic game **KZ Manager** was secretly distributed on Commodore 64 floppy disks across Europe. Players managed resources, bought gas and optimized the efficiency of a Nazi concentration camp. It was notoriously banned. Do you agree with the ban.”
 - * Information Ethical Idea board: Some games show ethical degradation itself as part of the educational game experience. This requires tact from authors to avoid encouraging harm endorsement over real groups, retraumatizing them, or without asking affected specifically targeted groups how they would like to be portrayed if high impersonations of them are used.
 - Do you think this contrasts acceptable games that endorse non-specific harms on non-specific groups? Would a game like *GTA* be more socially acceptable due to this, are there specific violations within the game.
 - PANE 2 - Discussion *then* poll:
 - * Why do we freely play historical war games where we slaughter ancient Romans, Spartans, or 18th-century soldiers, but recoil at games depicting recent genocides or the Holocaust? How much *time* or *generational distance* must pass before real human

trauma becomes “acceptable” material for a game engine? Does this require being sensitive to human collective trauma much like temperature?

- * Reveal a game: *RapeLay*. *The banned, originally on Amazon’s website, was a 2006 Japanese adult PC game required players to stalk and simulate the rape of a mother and her two daughters, earning points for acts of sexual violence, including tailing victims on commuter trains and forcing them to have abortions.*

- Are some harms eternal thematic human experiences. No amount of time will alter acceptance of concepts that are not historical and exist always as harms. Without arguing about the law, of “should” the game be banned, we argue about the information ethical nature.
- Is it a reflection of ethical decay or depravity if a gamer ignores the person hood of the people and healthier ways of consuming their experiences in data-ified form.

– PANE 3: Closing Discussion:

- * Do you align with **Ostritsch’s Endorsement View** (that endorsing real-world evil through game mechanics is an actual moral failure, not just a virtual one)?
- * Or do you align with **Schulzke’s Kantian/First Amendment defense** (that as long as no real living person is harmed in the “magic circle,” censorship over an individual’s historical or present day harm endorsements is a greater moral danger than repulsive pixel art).

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